

The Boston Globe

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SATURDAY, DECEMBER 13, 2025

New auction ordered for nursing home giant

Judge calls first effort ‘unfair,’ adds monitor

By Kay Lazar
GLOBE STAFF

In a ruling described as a win for taxpayers and patients, a bankruptcy judge in Texas late Thursday rejected the insider sale of Genesis HealthCare, saying the nursing home chain's secretive auction was “unfair” and needed to be redone, with the Justice Department monitoring the process.

The decision means that \$1.6 billion in claims from roughly 600 families and vendors, and other creditors against the troubled chain will not be erased, as they would have been under the previous deal.

“I just feel way too uncomfortable about so much of what I have heard,” Chief Judge Stacey G. C. Jernigan said about the testimony in her courtroom.

An unusual two-day hearing on the bankruptcy involved petitions from US senators and the Department of Justice to scuttle the deal, as well as allegations that the private-equity owner of Genesis, Joel Landau, threatened a competing bidder for his company.

With 49 facilities in New England, including two in Western Massachusetts, Genesis has a history of violations, from medication errors and improper care of bed sores, to physical and sexual abuse of residents. Health leaders closed one of its facilities in Connecticut in 2022 after the deaths of two patients and additional safety concerns.

GENESIS, Page A10

Abused teen’s family suing state agencies

Says oversight was lacking at group home

By Jason Laughlin
GLOBE STAFF

The family of a girl who was repeatedly raped at a Springfield group home when she was 14 years old sued the state Thursday, alleging state agencies failed to protect her from terrible conditions at the facility.

The Department of Children and Families and the Department of Early Education and Care failed to act on obvious signs of mismanagement at the home, Greylock, the suit states. Had agency workers provided sufficient oversight, according to the suit, they might have discovered the sexual assaults that occurred from October to December 2023.

A former night supervisor at Greylock, Xavier Cruz, 34, of Springfield, has pleaded not guilty to six counts of aggravated rape, among other charges. He is accused of assaulting the girl while he was a worker at the home, one of about 130 group homes in Massachusetts that care for children with complex trauma or behavioral health needs. Many of those kids ended up in group homes after a judge decided they would be safer living apart from their parents or guardians.

The suit filed in Suffolk County Superior Court contends the teenage girl was a victim of negligence, including from state agencies well aware of how troubled group homes are in Massachusetts, and that the sexual assault con-

HOME, Page A10

US to investigate Boston for bias

White House says city’s housing policies discriminate against white residents

By Niki Griswold,
Andrew Brinker,
and Emma Platoff
GLOBE STAFF

The Trump administration said Thursday it is investigating whether Boston's housing policies violate the federal Fair Housing Act, escalating its efforts to use landmark civil rights laws to target diversity, equity, and inclusion policies.

In a letter to Mayor Michelle Wu, Craig Trainor, assistant US secretary for fair housing and equal opportunity, accused Boston of discriminating against white people and prioritizing people of color, rather than all low-income residents, in its efforts to support homeownership and affordable housing development. The investigation suggests Trump housing officials intend to target as discriminatory lo-

cal programs that aim to level inequities created by decades of racial discrimination.

Quoting from the city's own racial justice initiatives, Trainor wrote city officials “have set out to smuggle ‘racial equity into every layer of operations in City government.’”

“To this dubious end, the City of Boston (the City) has developed and intends to implement discriminatory housing policies in violation of the Fair Housing Act,” Trainor wrote.

The investigation could result in discrimination charges or a referral

to the US Department of Justice, he said.

In a statement, a spokesperson for Wu rejected the accusations as “unhinged attacks from Washington.”

“Boston will never abandon our commitment to fair and affordable housing, and we will defend our progress to keep Bostonians in their homes,” the spokesperson said.

Housing specialists told the Globe that invoking the 1968 Fair Housing Act — passed to rectify the country's history of residential segregation and

HOUSING, Page A7

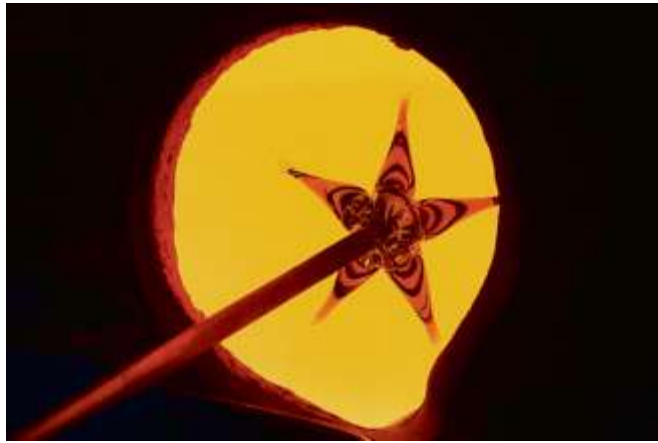
A GLASS ACT



At The Glass Studio on Cape Cod, owners Michael and Keiko Magyar have been busy crafting close to 1,000 ornaments for the holiday season.

Above, Michael Magyar, a master glassblower, used a powerful blowtorch to reheat a Christmas ornament as he formed it at his bench.

At right, a glass star attached to a stainless steel pipe was heated in the furnace to make it pliable. B3.



PHOTOS BY JOHN TLUMACKI/GLOBE STAFF

Globe editor Barnes stepping down

Was first woman to hold role at paper

By Aidan Ryan
GLOBE STAFF

Nancy Barnes, the editor of The Boston Globe since early 2023, announced to staff Friday that she is stepping down from her role at the end of next week.

In a note to the Globe newsroom, Barnes said she will stay on staff as an editor-at-large and hopes to work on a fund-raising initiative focused on

serving news deserts in New England.

“It’s time for me to take a break from the daily firestorm of news, consider new challenges and tend to some personal issues,” Barnes said in the email. “This is a special newsroom, full of dedicated journalists with big hearts, who are driven to deliver great journalism day in and day out — as you have these last three

years. It has been my great privilege to work with you.”

In an email to Boston Globe Media employees on Friday, co-owner and CEO Linda Henry said she would share further updates about the Globe's leadership soon.

“Over the past three years, Nancy has led the Globe newsroom with extraordinary dedication, guiding us through this historic news cycle and helping us deliver exceptional and

BARNES, Page A7

‘In many ways, it’s starting to feel like death by a thousand cuts’

This year, Harvard ran a \$113 million operating deficit, its first since the COVID-19 pandemic.



BEN PENNINGTON FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

As negotiations with Trump continue, cuts spread at Harvard

By Aidan Ryan and Diti Kohli
GLOBE STAFF

The Trump administration's efforts to remake Harvard University have slowed considerably since an initial onslaught of funding cuts was rejected in federal court. But as the fall semester comes to a close, the casualties on campus are adding up.

Harvard is already under financial strain, and expected changes in federal grants and a forthcoming endowment tax have led to job cuts across several

schools, lower graduate student admissions, and drawn-out negotiations with campus unions. And while grant funding has flowed back to campus after a September legal ruling, researchers still aren't operating at full capacity as they brace for possible further changes.

“It’s a lot more quiet, and we’re not really getting much news,” said Matthew Tobin, a Harvard junior. “But in many ways, it’s starting to feel like death by a thousand cuts.”

This year, Harvard ran a \$113 million operating deficit, its first since the COVID-19 pandemic, despite strong endowment returns and a record number of current-use gifts. Harvard is capable of liquidating assets and can tap its en-

HARVARD, Page A7

Marcel Vernon Sr. stepped down as chief executive at the Massachusetts Convention Center Authority after roughly a year in the position. D1.

Three Boston police officers violated department policy when they disregarded a supervisor's orders during a high-speed chase that ended in a deadly crash in early 2024, an internal review found. B1.



The colden touch

Saturday: Cloudy, windy. High: 35-40. Low: 27-32.

Sunday: Snow, flurries. High: 29-34. Low: 15-20.

Sunrise: 7:05 Sunset: 4:12

Comics and Weather, D4-5.

Obituaries, C9.

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